Make sure you don't boil the soup after adding the miso paste, as it spoils the flavor. You'll find wakame (dried seaweed) and miso in large supermarkets.

# miso soup with tuna

**SERVES** 4 **PREP** 25 MINS **COOK** 15 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

4in (10cm) piece wakame
2 tbsp dried shiitake mushrooms
2 scallions, chopped
1 tsp grated fresh ginger
1 long thin carrot, thinly sliced
2 cups chicken stock
7oz (200g) fresh tuna steak, diced
2 tbsp miso paste
soy sauce, to season
1 tbsp snipped chives

1 Put the wakame and mushrooms in a bowl and cover with cold water. Soak for 15 minutes. Drain, reserving the liquid. Lift out the wakame, remove any hard central ribs, and cut into strips.

2 Put the wakame, mushrooms, scallions, ginger, and carrot into a saucepan. Combine 1¼ cups of the soaking water with the stock and add to the saucepan. Bring to a boil, reduce the heat, cover, and simmer for 10 minutes until the carrot is just tender.

3 Add the tuna and cook for another 5 minutes. In a small bowl, blend the miso paste with 2 tbsp water and stir in to the soup. Season to taste with soy sauce. Heat through but do not boil. Ladle into warm soup cups and sprinkle with snipped chives.